

# Constitution of the Bell Tower Boys

Edited August 31st 2024 by Evan Golden

Approved by the Bell Tower Boys on \_\_\_\_\_

## I. Mission Statement

- A. The Bell Tower Boys are an a cappella group composed of students with varying backgrounds, experience, and disciplines. We strive to bring high quality entertainment to the Greenville community while building connections and lifting each other up.

## II. Membership

- A. Any current Furman student is welcome to audition for the group.
- B. We do not exclude students from membership based on gender, race, age, or ability.
- C. Current members may remain members without an additional audition as long as the member is a Furman student, assuming that the member is not expelled.
- D. Members who maintain Furman student status but cannot participate in the group for a time due to studying away (or similar circumstances) may take a leave of absence by communicating with the officers. They would not need another audition upon returning.
- E. Membership in The Bell Tower Boys is always voluntary.
- F. Members who voluntarily give up membership must audition again to rejoin.

## III. Member expectations

- A. Attendance policy
  - 1. All members are expected to attend all rehearsals and meetings.
  - 2. Exceptions
    - a) Events required for coursework
    - b) Illness
    - c) Unavoidable emergencies
    - d) Family obligations (discretion of the officers)
  - 3. Non-exceptions include:
    - a) Homework
    - b) CLPs not part of coursework
    - c) Social/extracurricular activities
  - 4. Arriving tardy for two rehearsals counts as an absence upon the second tardy
  - 5. If any member misses three out of seven consecutive rehearsals without a valid exception, they will be automatically on probation.

6. If any member misses three out of the seven rehearsals without a valid exception leading up to a performance, they are not eligible for solos on that performance, unless a majority of the officers make an exception.
- B. Rehearsal
1. Members should have access to their sheet music at rehearsal.
  2. Members should be familiar with music they have already had the opportunity to learn.
  3. Members should be without the influence of drugs or alcohol at rehearsal.
  4. Members should stay at rehearsal for the entire scheduled duration, and may leave at the scheduled ending time without penalty.
- C. Performances
1. Members should have a plan to arrive on time to every performance.
  2. Members should have the prepared materials and dress for every performance.
  3. The same exceptions as above apply to performance attendance.
- D. Other responsibilities
1. Members should always treat others with respect, whether BTB members or not, at BTB events and meetings.
  2. Members should assist the Publicity Officer in the promotion of BTB events.
  3. Members should not use their phones during rehearsal or meetings except for rehearsal or business purposes.

## IV. Officer responsibilities

- A. President
1. Lead business meetings
  2. Conduct official university communications and SGA communications
  3. Conduct communications outside of the group
  4. Frequently check the Gmail
  5. Make room reservations and schedule events in SyncDin
  6. Help other officers fulfill their responsibilities as necessary
- B. Vice President
1. Take attendance
  2. Take detailed notes of business meeting proceedings
  3. Inform the group of pertinent information with regular weekly emails
  4. Administer elections
- C. Music Director
1. Lead music rehearsals
  2. Assign voice parts
  3. Conduct performances
  4. Decide performance material
  5. Make practice tracks
  6. Administer auditions
- D. Treasurer

1. Maintain knowledge and control of TR Bank account
  2. Make SGA budget requests
  3. Propose purchases to the officers
  4. Manage group purchases
- E. Publicity Officer
1. Post weekly during the academic year on the BTB instagram or a similar platform
  2. Construct and publish event and audition posters
  3. Promote all public BTB events and all auditions
  4. Record and publish performance videos
- F. *All officers have the following responsibilities:*
1. Make plans for members to have probation lifted
  2. Work together to decide rehearsal and meeting times

## V. Meetings

- A. Rehearsals, meetings
1. The Bell Tower Boys should hold at least two rehearsals during regular academic weeks, and at least one rehearsal every week if possible.
  2. At least once per calendar month, the officers should hold a meeting to discuss the below items (discussion is not limited to the below items). Any member may attend business meetings, but unless the member is specifically invited to speak, only officers may take part in official discussions. Additional “emergency” meetings may occur at the officers’ discretion.
    - a) Monitor group progress
    - b) Make plans for the near and far future
    - c) Review probation plans
    - d) Review purchase proposals from the Treasurer
- B. How to schedule meetings
1. At the beginning of each semester, the officers are responsible for determining the regular weekly schedule.
  2. At any point, a majority of the officers may agree to schedule or reschedule a meeting.
  3. If the entire group is not informed of a new or rescheduled meeting with at least 7 days notice, any member’s absence may be excused within reason (determined by the officers).

## VI. Performances

- A. How to schedule a performance
1. The officers will convene to pick one or more potential performance dates and times.
  2. During a rehearsal with most of the group present, the group will come to a consensus for a performance date and time.
  3. The President should reserve the performance space and post the performance in Sync Din.

4. The Music Director should plan the setlist for the performance and coordinate with any guest artists.
- B. Promoting the performance
  1. The Publicity Officer should promote the concert for at least 14 days before the performance.
  2. The promotion should be through signage in public university spaces, social media, and word of mouth.
  3. The Publicity Officer may enlist the help of group members for any promotion effort.
- C. Attire
  1. The President will decide the attire for all events.
  2. Members should assist each other by sharing/borrowing attire items if a member does not have the required items.
  3. If a member needs help affording an attire item, the officers may agree to use some of the budget to purchase the item.

## VII. Auditions

- A. Planning the auditions
  1. The officers will agree on the time of auditions, preferably during a regular rehearsal time.
  2. The President should reserve the room and post the event to Sync Din.
  3. The Publicity Officer should promote the auditions at least 14 days in advance.
- B. Audition process/Candidates should:
  1. Enter the room one at a time
  2. Introduce themselves
  3. Sing a short excerpt (about one minute) unaccompanied (they may use a starting pitch)
  4. Test their voice range with the Music Director
  5. Sing a harmonization exercise with the group
  6. Tell a joke
  7. Leave the room before voting occurs
- C. Decisions
  1. After each candidate, the present group members vote by majority to admit or deny the candidate for membership.

*Note: The group members may choose to consider the candidate's singing ability, attitude, and character in the voting process.*
  2. The President should notify the admitted candidates by email of their acceptance and invite them to the next rehearsal.
  3. The President should individually notify the rejected candidates by email of their rejection.

## VIII. Elections

- A. Nominations

1. At the rehearsal before elections, the Vice President will collect nominations from all members for all positions.
  2. Members may nominate themselves.
  3. Members may hold nominations for multiple positions.
  4. Members may elect unanimously to leave a position vacant for a period of time, leaving the responsibilities to the President.
- B. Speeches and Discussion
1. For each position, nominated members will speak about their plans in their position before voting.
  2. The nominated members may answer questions asked by the group after the speech.
  3. The nominated members will leave the room while the remaining members have a discussion about who will be the best fit for the position.
  4. In the case of only one nominee for a position, there will be no speech or discussion.
- C. Voting
1. With a two-thirds majority or more of the active members present, elections will occur in the following order:
    - a) President
    - b) Vice President
    - c) Music Director
    - d) Treasurer
    - e) Publicity Officer
  2. Elections will proceed by secret written anonymous ballot.
  3. All members will vote for each office.
  4. Members may vote for themselves.
  5. The current Vice President will administer the elections. The Vice President may vote as well.
  6. No member may hold multiple offices except in the case of low membership.
  7. In the case of only one nominee for a position, the group may unanimously agree to appoint the nominee to the position.
- D. Replacement Vote
1. If any office is vacant due to leave of absence, expulsion, or a member giving up their membership/position, there will be an election to fill the office at the next rehearsal.
  2. Members may elect unanimously to leave a position vacant for a period of time, leaving the responsibilities to the President.
  3. The Vice President will administer this election.

## IX. Probation

### A. Warnings

1. The above categories list responsibilities for members and officers; failure to complete tasks (infraction) will result in discipline listed in this article.

2. At any point after an infraction, the Vice President (or the President, if the group member in question is the Vice President) may issue a verbal or written warning to the violating group member, explaining the probation process.
3. Warnings should contain a suggestion for improved behavior and should offer help.

B. How someone is put on probation

1. Any group member who exhibits a pattern of failing to uphold their member expectations may be placed on probation by a majority vote of the officers, effective immediately.
2. Any officer who fails to uphold their officer duties as outlined in the articles above may be placed on probation by a majority vote of the other officers, effective immediately.
  - a) The President should fulfill any duties that the officer on probation fails to fulfill.
  - b) The President may enlist the help of other members for these duties.
  - c) Any group members are encouraged to voice their concerns about an officer's behavior.
3. See the above attendance policy for automatic probation.

C. What happens when someone is on probation

1. Members on probation may not have solos in performance or receive new merchandise not related to performances. Members on probation are still expected to perform and participate in all BTB activities, unless specified by the terms of the officers.
2. Officers on probation due to infractions related to their officer duties may not vote when officers are called to a vote.
3. The officers not on probation will discuss the reason for the probation of the member in question, and will formulate a plan with terms for the member to leave probation.
4. The plan may involve the officer in question relinquishing their officer position while remaining a member of the group.
5. The member on probation must attend a meeting led by the President to negotiate terms for leaving probation. The member and the officers will agree on a plan.

D. How to leave probation

1. Once the member has fulfilled the terms for their probation, the officers will vote to release the member from probation, effective immediately.
2. The member may have as many meetings with the officers as necessary for the assistance of the member.
3. The purpose of probation is to assist the member to succeed in their role as a member and/or officer.

E. Expulsion

1. If a member has not fulfilled their terms of probation for two weeks, the officers not on probation may vote by consensus to expel the member. Effective immediately, the member in question is no longer a Bell Tower Boy, and must wait until the next semester to audition again.
2. If the expelled member is an officer, the remaining officers will nominate a new officer from the members and initiate a Replacement Vote as outlined above.
3. Under special circumstances, the officers may elect to expel a member in order to protect the public image of the group. Grounds for expulsion include, but are not limited to:
  - a) Academic integrity violation
  - b) Sexual assault allegation/conviction
  - c) Poor academic performance (officers may decide to put member on probation at their discretion)
  - d) Instances of bullying or violence

## X. Revision

- A. At least once per academic year, the officers must meet to revise or supplement the terms in this document. The officers may suggest no change if they feel that the terms are suitable.
- B. Any changes proposed must be approved by a majority vote of the members at a rehearsal.